

RESUME ETIQUETTE

Skill Development Cell, IIT Madras



Message from the Team

Hello everyone! Here are a few tips and resources to help you create a resume for the forthcoming Campus Placement Programme 2024–2025. This could serve as a short checklist to make sure all the information has been included and formatted as efficiently as feasible for your resume.

We hope the information in this PDF will be helpful to you as the deadline approaches. Please don't only think of them as rules; think of them as ideas. These are a compilation of ideas from several resume-writing workshops, and they serve as broad recommendations for all industries and job types.

We appreciate the assistance in developing these standards from the AAS Clubs and the Placement & Internship team.

If you come across any inconsistencies with the recommendations stated in this text, kindly contact us at cdc@smail.iitm.ac.in.

General Points

Fonts and Color Scheme:

- Font Size: It is preferable to have a font size between 9 to 12. (Best: Font size of '10' for the content and '12' for the headings)
- Fonts that are preferred by most:
 - Sans Serif fonts like: **Calibri**, **Arial**, Tahoma, Verdana, Helvetica
 - Serif fonts like: Garamond, **Times New Roman**
- Keep the size of the resume strictly within an A4 sheet (Don't try to have a bigger-sized paper to include the content; Trust us the firms can figure out)
- Number of colors: A maximum of 3 colors (this includes the background color as well). Please use shades of the same color rather than using completely different ones.
 - Best colors on a resume are **Black**, **White** and **Blue**. They appear modern, trustworthy and grab the reader's attention without being distracting.

Formatting content:

- Try to exclude **blank spaces** as much as possible. There is no hard rule as to how much white space you should have in the resume. It is recommended to

have **450-600 words** on your resume in total (a 2-2.5 minute read).

- **Quantify** your achievements, results and strategies as much as possible (Putting out numbers is important). <Insert Examples>
- Always use bullet points for content within a particular sub-section. Paragraphs make the resumes seem cluttered. Use **Action Verbs** to describe the points. Never write complete sentences or repeat content in the resume. (A list of action verbs for different profiles and skill sets have been provided at the end of this document.)
- Use the **STAR** and **CAR** formats to structure your points. STAR: Situation, Task, Action, Result and CAR: Challenge, Action, Result.
- Headings/sections to be included in a resume are:
 - Education
 - Scholastic Achievements
 - Skills (primarily technical and software skills are included in the section)
 - Professional Experience (Such as internships/jobs previously held)
 - Projects
 - Courses
 - Positions of Responsibilities
 - Co-curricular Activities
 - Extracurricular activities

NOTE: It is not necessary to include all of the above sections. Analyse your strong suit and create profile-specific resumes.

- Formats commonly used in resumes:

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1cxUGIkQ5Q8ECbEtdD5ncGkuwYXPWJaLU?usp=drive_link

Profile-Specific resumes are better!

- Focus only on the qualifications, skills, and occupational goals that are related to the position to which you're applying.
- Create several versions of your resume. This allows you to highlight your qualifications for different types of jobs.
- Do not make statements that you cannot prove!

Action Verbs:

For Engineering/Technical roles:

• Conceptualised	• Computed • Extrapolated
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• Predicted	• Installed • Engineered
• Calculated	• Segmented • Restructured
• Arbitrated	• Estimated • Overhauled
• Devised	• Assembled • Unified
• Visualised	• Debugged • Customised
• Standardised	• Steered • Validated
• Diagnosed	• Tested • Automated

• Strengthened • Troubleshooted • Architected • Discovered •
Deployed • Added

Design and Creative Skills:

• Acted	• Correlated • Customised
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• Designed	• Developed • Directed
• Established	• Fashioned • Illustrated
• Instituted	• Integrated • Performed
• Planned	• Proved • Revised
• Revitalised	• Streamlined • Structured
• Shaped	• Tabulated • Validated

Financial Skills:

• Administered	• Allocated • Analysed
• Appraised	• Audited • Balanced
• Budgeted	• Calculated • Computed

• Managed	• Planned • Projected
• Researched	• Restructured • Modelled

Process Improvement, Consulting and Operations:

• Combined	• Consolidated • Converted
• Decreased	• Devised • Eliminated
• Expanded	• Improved • Increased
• Innovated	• Minimised • Maximised
• Modernised	• Recommended • Refined
• Reorganised	• Resolved • Revised
• Serviced	• Simplified • Transformed

• Unified • Widened • Broadened

• Revamped	• Collaborated • Trimmed
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Problem Solving Skills:

• Arranged	• Composed • Conceived
• Controlled	• Co-ordinated • Investigated
• Itemised	• Operated • Prepared
• Processed	• Produced • Reviewed
• Scheduled	• Simplified • Transformed

Research and Analysis Skills:

• Classified	• Assessed • Collated
• Defined	• Devised • Evaluated
• Forecasted	• Identified • Traced

• Researched	• Tested • Interpreted
• Verified	• Uncovered • Clarified
• Collected	• Critiqued • Diagnosed
• Extracted	• Inspected • Inspired
• Organised • Surveyed	• Reviewed • Summarised • Systemised • Interviewed

Management Skills:

• Chaired	• Consolidated • Assigned
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• Delegated	• Contracted • Directed
• Executed	• Guided • Planned
• Prioritised	• Produced • Recommended
• Scheduled	• Supervised • Managed

Entrepreneurial Skills:

• Created	• Composed • Conceived
• Established • Implemented	• Founded • Generated • Launched • Led
• Opened	• Originated • Pioneered
• Promoted	• Started • Released